

sheet foolproof to any complications that might arise otherwise due to unexpected input conditions.

Leveraging the power of grouping

Group is a powerful analytical tool that can allow you to perform some complex operations. It's one of the top sub-sections of the Pivot Table function. You can group various months within a year and then perform calculations based on that grouping.

2019 Excel has some excellent grouping functionalities that can alleviate many of the problems that arise with unsorted data. When data is properly organised, there is greater attention given to grouping tools within PT.

There are multiple grouping options available as well. For instance, the year and month can be grouped into separated functions. The final PT can be optimised to show “quarters” as well as “years” in the same function.

Grouping is a simple option available to all users that want to analyse their data better. They can also design better sorting and analysing within data sets. You can separate a year format from a month, to correlate the information better with secondary stats such as sales or launch data.

Grouping can also be done with text data so that you can create more meaningful correlations. You can assign certain values to text data as

The screenshot displays an Excel spreadsheet with a PivotTable. The PivotTable is titled 'www.contextures.com' and is structured as follows:

Sum of Quantity	Colu	East	West	Grand Total
Arrowroot	Arrowroot (Product)	2235	1016	3251
Banana	Banana (Product)	1471	1595	3066
Chocolate Chip	Chocolate Chip (Product)	783	528	1311
Bran	Bran (Product)	1219	637	1856
Carrot	Carrot (Product)	3547	2957	6504
Cheese	Cheese (Product)	64	64	128
Oatmeal Raisin	Oatmeal Raisin (Product)	2020	1084	3104
Pretzels	Pretzels (Product)	229	21	250
Saltines	Saltines (Product)			

The PivotTable Fields task pane on the right shows the following configuration:

- Choose fields to add to report:**
 - ☐ OrderDate
 - ☐ Region
 - ☐ City
 - ☐ Category
 - ☒ Product
 - ☒ Quantity
 - ☐ TotalPrice
 - ☒ Product2
- Drag fields between areas below:**
 - FILTERS:** Region
 - ROWS:** Product2, Product
 - VALUES:** Sum of Quantity

Example of grouping text items